

Justices look to end gun bans in 5 states

Laws forbid carrying firearms into stores and restaurants without consent.

By DAVID G. SAVAGE

WASHINGTON — Do licensed gun owners have a right to carry a loaded weapon into stores, restaurants and other private places that are open to the public? California and Hawaii are among five states with new laws that forbid carrying firearms onto private property without the consent of an owner or manager. But the Trump administration joined gun rights advocates on Tuesday in urging the Supreme Court to strike down the laws as unconstitutional under the 2nd Amendment.

Such a law “effectively nullifies licenses to carry arms in public,” Trump’s lawyers said.

If you stop at a gasoline station, “you’re committing a crime” if you do not have the owner’s consent, Deputy Solicitor Gen. Sarah Harris told the court.

An attorney representing Hawaii said the issue is one of property rights, not gun rights.

“An invitation to shop is not an invitation to bring your Glock,” Washington attorney Neal Katyal told the court. “There is no constitutional right to assume that every invitation to enter private property includes an invitation to bring a gun.”

The justices sounded split along the usual ideological lines, with the court’s conservatives signaling they are likely to strike down the new laws in five Democratic-tilted states.

“You are just relegating the 2nd Amendment to second-class status,” Justice Samuel A. Alito Jr. told Katyal.

He said the court had ruled law-abiding persons have a right to carry a firearm for self-defense when they leave home. That would include going to stores or businesses that are open to the public.

“Could Hawaii enact a statute that says that if you

[See Guns, A8]



Photographs by RONALDO BOLANOS Los Angeles Times

DAVID BARLAG with his dog Austin beside a vandalized lamp he fitted with solar power. Thieves also hit a city yard stocked with replacement wire.

Wire thefts, city delays leave streets in the dark

Hancock Park residents use solar power and hire guards amid a months-long wait for lamp repairs

By Gavin J. Quinton

It’s been months since a swath of Hancock Park lost its streetlights — and it’ll be several more long months of what residents say are “pitch black” streets and roaming burglars before there’s a fix.

So neighbors have been improvising.

Last fall, copper thieves plundered about a dozen public streetlights over three city blocks, leaving their neighborhood in the dark.

A walk down Orange Drive feels treacherous — like “something out of the ‘Twilight Zone’” — one resident said.

“We’ve had car thefts. We’ve had break-ins. It just feels dangerous,” homeowner David Barlag added.

The thefts were reported to the city’s Public Works Department in October, but residents were met with a nine-month timeline for repairs.

To make matters worse, repair times could be further delayed after looters cleaned out a city storage yard housing a large amount of replacement wire, Los

Angeles Police Department Senior Lead Officer Harris Cho said at a recent meeting of the Wilshire Neighborhood Council.

“The actual warehouse that has all of the types of cables and wires that we need to fix these lights ... was broken into and all of that was stolen,” said Sixto Sicilia of the Greater Wilshire Neighborhood Council.

Neither the Police Department nor the Department of Public Works returned calls seeking comment.

So some Hancock Park residents — faced with a nearly yearlong wait before their streets emerge from the darkness — have tried to come up with their own solutions. Homeowners pooled their money to purchase and affix makeshift solar-powered lamps to the disabled lampposts.

Although they are of some help, visibility is still poor, Barlag said.

The problem is not unique to Hancock Park. Wire theft

[See Copper, A10]

Greenland bid poses a threat to global order

Takeover plan could destroy a system that has benefited the U.S. for over 75 years.

By MICHAEL WILNER AND ANA CEBALLOS

WASHINGTON — An unconstrained U.S. president has sided with Russia in its war of conquest in Europe, seized Venezuela’s dictator from his bed in an attempt to take control of that country’s oil, threatened military strikes against America’s closest neighbors and sent tariffs soaring on its friends.

Donald Trump has gotten away with it all — but his threats to annex Greenland, risking destruction of the Western alliance in its current form, may prove a breaking point in a global order that has benefited the United States for over 75 years.

Canada’s prime minister said Tuesday that the Trump administration’s boorish behavior marks a

“rupture,” not merely a transition, in the international system, away from a world where the United States could be relied upon as a force for good. American cardinals in the Catholic Church warned over the weekend that U.S. foreign policy had gone “morally adrift.” France’s president said that Europe now represents a rare refuge where predictability, loyalty, and rule of law still trump the “brutality” of “bullies.”

Trump’s effort to coax allies to his will on Greenland through another round of tariff hikes prompted panic in U.S. markets. The Dow Jones industrial average plunged nearly 900 points, the Standard & Poor’s 500 dropped 2%, and the Nasdaq composite fell over 500

[See Greenland, A8]

Newsom faults global leaders

In Switzerland, the governor criticizes “complicity” in countries’ dealings with Trump. **NATION, A8**

Studio lot hit by Hollywood slump

Lenders are taking over historic Radford site, where ‘Seinfeld,’ others were filmed.

By ROGER VINCENT

Radford Studio Center, the storied movie lot that gave Studio City its name, is in financial distress and is expected to be returned to lenders as declining film and television production racks the entertainment industry.

Formerly known as CBS Studio Center, the Los Angeles lot has been home to generations of landmark television shows including “Gunsmoke” and “Seinfeld.”

Hackman Capital Partners, one of the world’s largest independent studio operators, has defaulted on a \$1.1-billion mortgage and investment bank Goldman is leading a takeover of the historic property. Bloomberg first reported on the news.

The move follows Hackman’s aggressive push in recent years to buy up studios to capitalize on anticipated

growth, especially in the TV business. As of last year, the company had \$10 billion in assets under management.

Founded by silent film comedy legend Mack Sennett in 1928, the lot became known as “Hit City” in the decades after World War II as popular TV shows such as “Leave It to Beaver,” “Gilligan’s Island,” “The Mary Tyler Moore Show,” “The Bob Newhart Show” and “Will & Grace” were made there.

Culver City-based Hackman Capital Partners and Square Mile Capital Management teamed up to buy the Radford Avenue property from ViacomCBS in 2021 with a winning bid of \$1.85 billion after a competitive battle for the 55-acre studio beloved by the television industry.

At the time, the staggering price tag underscored the value — and scarcity — of TV soundstages in Los Angeles as content producers scrambled for space to shoot TV shows and movies to stock their streaming services. It was one of the largest ever real estate transactions

[See Studio, A12]



MOSTAFA ALKHAROUF Anadolu

THE U.N. Relief and Works Agency’s Jerusalem offices are demolished Tuesday.

Israel razing refugee facilities

U.N. says action violates international law protecting sites

By SAM METZ

JERUSALEM — Israeli forces on Tuesday targeted at least two United Nations facilities, pushing forward with a crackdown against the U.N. agency for Palestinian refugees tasked with delivering humanitarian services to millions of people across the region.

Crews began bulldozing the United Nations Relief and Works Agency’s offices in Sheikh Jarrah and fired tear gas at a vocational

school in Qalandiya, marking Israel’s latest and most dramatic step against UNRWA.

Israel has long railed against the agency, accusing it of being infiltrated by the militant group Hamas and saying that some of its employees were involved in the October 2023 attack that triggered Israel’s two-year war in Gaza.

UNRWA leaders have said they took swift action against the employees accused of taking part in the attack, and have denied alle-

gations that the agency tolerates or collaborates with Hamas.

U.N. Secretary-General António Guterres on Tuesday condemned Israel’s destruction of the agency’s compound and called for it to be returned to the United Nations’ control.

“The Secretary-General views as wholly unacceptable the continued escalatory actions against UNRWA, which are inconsistent with Israel’s clear obligations under international

[See Refugees, A4]

Joining the \$1-million club
These enclaves have seen their typical home values cross the seven-digit mark. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

Chesney’s roots in small town
UCLA football coach was shaped by family and pigskin in former coal-mining community. **SPORTS, B10**

Predicting the Oscar nominees
Glenn Whipp shares his picks on what and who will snag awards nominations Thursday. **ENTERTAINMENT, E1**

Netflix amends purchase bid
Amid war with Paramount, the streaming company offers all cash for Warner Bros. **BUSINESS, A11**

Weather
Mostly cloudy. L.A. Basin: 68/52. **B5**
Markets **A13**
Opinion Voices **A14**

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Female directors becoming rarer

Their representation is down. But a new mentorship program hopes to change that.

By SAMANTHA MASUNAGA

Six years ago, Ally Pankiw got her first big TV breakthrough: She directed the first season of the Netflix comedy-drama “Feel Good.”

But getting there was a slog. She recalls being told repeatedly that she couldn’t land such jobs without first having directing experience in TV, a catch-22 situation shared by many women and people of color trying to break into the business.

Frustrated by that common refrain and motivated to push back against Hollywood’s larger diversity problem, Pankiw decided to take action.

She started to bring mentees to her sets, first paying them on commercial shoots from her own rate, then eventually asking film and TV productions to pay them as part of the budget.

The idea was for those aspiring directors to shadow her on set and get that firsthand knowledge about an industry that is so often out of reach.

Pankiw’s individual efforts have now grown into Breadcrumbs, a mentorship program she formally launched late last year that helps up-and-coming women and nonbinary directors get access to paid, credited shadowing opportunities on film, TV and commercial sets.

So far, she said, about 25 directors and production companies have signed a pledge to commit to these paid mentorship opportunities, including “Freakier Friday” director Nisha Ganatra and Lilly Wachowski of “The Matrix” franchise.

“We get told the myth that we as female directors or diverse directors are competing against each other for a very small amount of jobs,” said Pankiw, 39, who grew up outside Edmonton, Canada, and now splits time between Los Angeles and Toronto. “We’re actually not each oth-

[See Directors, A12]